

In a 2022 interview with *People* magazine promoting her program to empower young girls through sport, professional tennis player and mental health advocate Naomi Osaka said: “For me, the biggest lesson I’ve learned is to try to be present in each moment. It’s easy to lose sight of how far you’ve come, but I’ve been prioritizing trying to live in the moment and enjoy the journey.”

Write an essay that argues your position on the extent to which Osaka’s claim about embracing the present moment is valid.

In your response you should do the following:

- Respond to the prompt with a thesis that presents a defensible position.
- Provide evidence to support your line of reasoning.
- Explain how the evidence supports your line of reasoning.
- Use appropriate grammar and punctuation in communicating your argument.

Begin writing your essay below:

Professional tennis player Naomi Osaka quotes “ for me, the biggest lesson I'velearned is to try to be present in each moment. It's easy to lose sight of how far you've come, but I've been prioritizing trying to live in the moment and enjoy the journey." She argues that one of the biggest lessons of life is learning and having an understatement to stay in the here and nowand enjoy it rather than keep worrying and replaying situations that had happened in the past. Her claim is reasonable because embracing the present allows people to appreciate growth and to find meaning in experiences that may seem meaningless at the time. Her idea of living in the present rather than the past is true because it helps people change their mindsets and let them live their liveswithout so much worrying about their past. Too many people suffer from past regrets of what they should have done instead of what was done, and others worry so much about what may be in the future. As long as enjoy living at that moment of life and treasureevery second of the present because when people are thinking and worrying about

what comes next they can forget how much they already grew. Living in the moments helps people enjoy the journey instead of only caring about the ending.

A good example of this story is the story of a band called Panchiko. They have made music a long time ago, no one really listened to their songs or acknowledged them. Their cd was forgotten for many years. Later on there someone found one of their songs and published it online the song was called “D-E-A-T-H-M-E-T-A-L” and that when it all began a lot of people tuned in and started listening to the songs that the band had made. Their story shows that even though they weren't famous or anything like that, the work and effort they did in that moment still became important later on. This helps Naomi point, that the band made music because they enjoyed it without caring if they were gonna blow up or not. They did it with enjoyment, happiness, and a way to express their feelings while living in their present moments. Not knowing they would be popular now which leads them enjoying their present of success. If they only cared about being famous they might have given up. Instead they stayed and focused on what they loved in that moment and years later it became something special and memorable. Also, living in the present helps ease people's mind and helps them stay calm. If someone worries only about the future they can feel stressed and scared. But when they focus on what they are doing and enjoy every second of it they can do their best and enjoy the process. This can help people feel relaxed, happier, and stronger. In the end, Naomi Osaka's claim is valid because enjoying the present helps people grow and find happiness in their journey. The story of Panchiko shows that what people do in the moment can become meaningful later, even if they do not know it yet.

- Discovery of the song

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- The band not worrying whether they blow up or not

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